TROUBLESHOOTING GUIDE

Technical Support in Banking

A practical five-page reference for diagnosing common digital banking, ATM, card, payment, and access issues.

Purpose	Help support staff follow a consistent, secure process to identify issues, guide customers, record evidence, and escalate unresolved cases.
Audience	First-line help desk, branch support, contact-centre agents, and junior technical support teams.
Scope	Internet/mobile banking, login and OTP, cards and ATMs, UPI/transfers, and service outages.

Standard troubleshooting workflow

1. Identify	Ask what service failed, when it happened, the exact error message, and whether the issue affects one or multiple users.
2. Verify safely	Use approved identity-verification steps. Never ask for a PIN, password, full card number, CVV, or OTP.
3. Check basics	Confirm service status, network connectivity, app/browser version, device time, and whether the customer can access other services.
4. Test carefully	Use approved low-risk checks. Avoid repeated payment attempts when the transaction status is uncertain.
5. Record & resolve	Document timestamps, reference IDs, error codes, checks performed, customer impact, and the final outcome.
6. Escalate	Route suspected fraud, money movement discrepancies, widespread outages, and security incidents to the appropriate team immediately.

Safety first: This is a general training guide, not a substitute for a bank's internal runbooks, regulator requirements, or approved customer-verification procedures.

1. Login, Internet Banking & Mobile App

Use this section when a customer cannot sign in, the app freezes, a page fails to load, or an OTP is not received.

A. Login failure or account locked

- **Confirm the symptom:** incorrect credentials, account locked, blank page, session timeout, or an error code.
- **Check service status:** look at the approved internal status page or incident channel before changing customer settings.
- **Check input:** confirm username format, keyboard language, Caps Lock, and whether the official login page/app is being used.
- **Use the official recovery route:** guide the customer to the bank's password/username recovery process. Do not collect their password.
- **Repeated lockout:** stop repeated attempts and follow the bank's unlock or identity-verification workflow.

B. App crashes, freezes, or shows a network error

- Ask the customer to check internet connectivity and try switching between Wi-Fi and mobile data, if safe and available.
- Check whether the app is updated from the official app store and whether the device operating system is supported.
- Close and reopen the app. If approved, clear the app cache; explain that clearing app data may remove local settings or require re-registration.
- Check device date/time settings and available storage. Restart the device only after confirming no transaction is in progress.
- If the issue persists, record app version, device/OS, time, error text, and affected function for technical escalation.

C. OTP or verification code not received

- Confirm the registered mobile number/email is current using the bank's approved process; never ask the customer to read out an OTP.
- Check mobile signal, SMS inbox capacity, notification settings, and whether messages are blocked or delayed.
- Use the official resend option only within the bank's permitted limits. Do not encourage repeated rapid requests.
- If a customer receives an OTP they did not request, treat it as a possible security event and follow the fraud-reporting process.

Escalate immediately if the customer reports an unexpected login alert, an unknown device, a password reset they did not request, or suspected account takeover.

2. UPI, Transfers & Payment Problems

Common symptoms include pending transfers, failed payments, duplicate-looking entries, or a debit without a visible credit.

A. First checks

- Ask for the approximate time, amount, payment channel, recipient bank/name where appropriate, and transaction/reference ID.
- Check the transaction status in the bank's approved system and confirm whether the entry is pending, failed, reversed, or successful.
- Check for a known payment-rail or bank incident using the approved operations dashboard.
- Do not ask the customer to share their UPI PIN, OTP, full card details, or screen-sharing access.

B. Common scenarios and safe action

Scenario	Support action	Avoid
Payment pending	Check status and reference ID; follow the bank's stated processing/reconciliation window.	Do not immediately retry if outcome is unknown.
Debited, recipient not credited	Log a dispute with transaction details and route to payments/reconciliation team.	Do not promise an instant reversal.
Payment failed	Verify final status and reversal timeline from official system/policy.	Do not rely only on a screenshot or SMS.
Possible duplicate	Compare transaction IDs, timestamps, and ledger status; raise a duplicate-payment case if confirmed.	Do not assume two alerts mean two completed debits.
Wrong recipient	Escalate promptly under the bank's dispute process and preserve evidence.	Do not guarantee recovery or contact a recipient on the customer's behalf outside policy.

C. Payment incident checklist

- Record the transaction/reference ID, channel, date/time, amount, status, and customer impact in the approved case system.
- Use the official dispute process and give only the timeline stated by the bank or payment provider.
- If fraud is suspected, advise the customer to contact the bank immediately through an official channel and follow local reporting procedures.

Never request a customer to install remote-access software, share a screen showing banking credentials, or transfer money to a 'safe account' to fix a technical issue.

3. ATM, Card, Service Outage & Security Issues

A. ATM or card transaction failed

- Confirm whether the ATM dispensed cash, whether the card was returned, and whether the account was debited.
- Record ATM location/terminal ID if available, transaction time, amount, and any receipt or error code.
- For cash-not-dispensed or card-debit discrepancies, file a case using the bank's approved ATM dispute process.
- For a lost/stolen card or suspected compromise, use the bank's official card-blocking channel immediately; do not wait for routine troubleshooting.
- Do not request or record the customer's PIN or CVV. Never ask them to test a card by sharing sensitive details.

B. Multiple users cannot access a service

- Determine the scope: one customer, one branch/region, one channel, or multiple channels.
- Check approved monitoring for authentication, network, API, database, payment gateway, and vendor incidents.
- Collect start time, affected service, error pattern, impacted region, and any recent approved change.
- Open or update the incident record; follow severity classification, communications, and escalation rules.
- Do not announce a root cause until it is confirmed by the responsible technical team.

C. Security and fraud warning signs

- Unknown transactions, unexpected OTPs, unfamiliar beneficiaries, suspicious login alerts, or a customer being coached by a caller.
- Customer says they shared credentials or installed an app at another person's request.
- Potential phishing, SIM-swap, malware, or account-takeover indicators.

Response: stop routine troubleshooting, follow the bank's fraud/security escalation procedure, help the customer secure access using official channels, and preserve case evidence. In India, suspected cyber financial fraud can be reported through the official national cybercrime helpline 1930; use verified official channels.

D. Quick triage table

Priority	Examples	Action
Critical	Suspected fraud, data exposure, widespread outage, money movement risk	Immediate escalation through incident/security procedure
High	Multiple customers blocked from a key service	Raise incident and monitor updates
Normal	Single-user app or login issue without security indicators	Follow first-line checklist; escalate if unresolved

4. Ticket Documentation, Escalation & Closure

A complete support ticket helps the next team reproduce the issue without exposing sensitive customer data.

A. Required ticket fields

- **Case details:** ticket ID, date/time with timezone, channel, issue category, and severity.
- **Customer impact:** what the customer was trying to do, number of affected users if known, and business impact.
- **Technical evidence:** exact error text/code, application version, device/OS or browser, relevant transaction/reference ID, and approved diagnostic logs.
- **Steps taken:** checks performed, results, workarounds offered, and why the case is being escalated.
- **Privacy:** store only necessary information in approved systems. Mask account/card identifiers and never place passwords, PINs, CVVs, or OTPs in tickets.

B. Escalation handoff template

Summary	Customer cannot complete [service/action]; observed error: [exact message].
When / scope	[date/time/timezone]; [single user / multiple users / region].
Reference	[ticket ID and approved transaction/reference ID; mask sensitive identifiers].
Checks	[service status, connectivity, app version, approved diagnostics] and results.
Impact / urgency	[customer impact, money movement or security risk, priority].
Requested action	[reconciliation, application, network, identity, card, or security team review].

C. Before closing a case

- Confirm the service works or that the responsible team has accepted ownership of the unresolved issue.
- Explain the outcome and any next steps in clear language; provide the ticket/reference number.
- Document the resolution, customer confirmation where required, and any follow-up commitment.
- If a workaround was used, confirm it is approved and does not weaken security or bypass controls.

Reference links for further reading

- Central Bank of India customer care and digital banking support: centralbank.bank.in/en/customer_care
- State Bank of India contact centre and service guidance: sbi.bank.in/en/web/customer-care/contact-centre
- Bank of India safe banking guidance: bankofindia.bank.in/safe-banking
- DBS Bank login troubleshooting FAQ: dbs.bank.in login issues FAQs

Reminder: Procedures and timelines differ by bank, payment rail, transaction type, and jurisdiction. Always use the institution's current approved runbooks and customer-facing guidance.